

The death of a PC

Dear Digit,
Congratulations! You have blown up our PC by suggesting that we use software such as SoftFSB. In no time, it multiplied our Celeron 900 MHz 4 times! Now, could we just ask you to be kind, and send us a cheque of Rs 10,000 for the repairs that you have literally thrust upon us?

Thanking you,
Anant and Shantanu
Via e-mail



ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

Dear Anant and Shantanu,
You have our sympathies for your loss. Over-clocking your PC is always a hazardous task, as we point out in every article that shows you how to go about doing it. Where a 10 per cent increase is considered significant, pushing your system to 4 times its rated speed is certain to melt every chip. We publish your letter here as a cautionary note to all our readers—the speed gain by over-clocking brings with it a corresponding risk of burn out. Please be careful.

digit

Crack who?

Dear Sir,
Please do include software such as 3D Studio Max, Partition Magic, etc., in your forthcoming Digit interactive CDs. Also, increase the number of games, and reduce the useless funzone games. The bitter truth is that the popularity of your magazine is due to the crackdigit site. The more cracks available, the more popular will your magazine be. As the crackdigit site is down, I cannot find cracks to some of the games. I suggest that you entrust someone with the task of developing cracks.

Thanks,
Sartaj Sharma
Via e-mail

Dear Sartaj,
Over the last couple of issues, we have been discussing the ills of piracy in this space. Just to make it absolutely clear, we are not in any way associated with any crackdigit site, and are most certainly not getting into the business of “developing cracks” for software.

digit

Buying trouble

Dear Sumod,
With reference to the July 2003 editorial, I feel that India is the only country in the world where the customer for a computer peripheral has to go through ordeals that have no parallels. The importer, distributor, and the reseller mafia here, is unheard of in the other parts of the world. There are ‘n’ number of online stores abroad, from where you can buy PC components. ‘If they’re made, they’re available’ is their motto.



However, try buying any component in India, and you are almost sure to be taken for a ride. Replacement and repair problems are better left unsaid.

Thank you for acknowledging our plight and highlighting our woes.

Sartaj Sharma
Via e-mail

Dear Sumod,
Apropos the editorial dated July 2003, the smoke screen is not yet completely off. Kudos for acknowledging the ground realities, and the deplorable state the customer is in today—an act long overdue.

Prices for a SATA hard disk are not available with the reseller because the distributor feels that there is no market for these drives. CRT monitors are withdrawn from the market overnight since the TFTs do not sell if their cheap cousins are around! Indeed, call centres know nothing about prices, or anything for that matter.

Big bullies, importing motherboards and processors, see which way the wind is blowing before answering your queries about an 875 chipset! Lamington road ‘gurus’ still wake up at 10 am, have lunch, and then tell you that the PC components have yet to come, which, in their parlance, means that the ‘rate for the day’ for all the parts is still being worked out. Don’t be surprised if CPUs prices fall by 20 per cent between the time of purchase, and the arrival of the 3.43 Virar fast at Dahisar. The business carried out at Dalal Street seems to be far safer.

Ravi Mahadevan
Via e-mail

digit

Dear Raja and Ravi,
Your experiences resonate loud and clear with all of us who have had the opportunity to buy PC components in the ‘grey’ market. The stories are always the same, the excuses are quite predictable. The problem is compounded by the fact that it is the rare reseller who has both knowledge, and the right attitude.

digit READERPOLLS

Your vote counts

Q. Do you think publishing bad after-sales experiences that our readers endure will help improve vendor's service levels?

Yes	No
75.4%	24.6%

This month's question:

Question: Your reason for not trying Linux yet?

Don't know why I should try
Too hard to install/use
My favourite application missing
Linux rules my desktop!

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote